

This meeting of the Tech Valley Game Space Board of Directors was held on Monday, 6/1/2026, starting at 6:00 pm EDT and ending at 7:54pm EDT.

The following members of the board were in attendance via teleconference:

Taro Omiya (Chair of the Board)

Jamey Stevenson (Executive Director)

Jordan Faas-Bush (Acting Secretary)

Heath Gartner

Laquana Cooke

Tom Carmona

Darryl Nunn

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The board has a quorum at 6:03 pm.

Motion to make Jordan acting secretary at 6:08 passed with no naves.

6:09 started first agenda item reviewing the consent agenda

6:12 did new member introductions to the rest of the board members

6:16 jumped to onboarding new members to review the guidelines for board member participation

Afterwards returned back to the agenda order, went over a summary of the agendas to approve

6:22 motion to approve consent agendas by Jamey, seconded by Tom, motion passed with no naves

Agenda item 2c reviewing the vision and mission document for TVGS. Taro read out the document for all the board members. Reviewed the 5 year goals since those don't seem to have been updated since 2022. Read through them, Jamey mentioned it would be nice to do a longer review+revamp of them. Heath mentioned that it would be useful to review what has been completed in the existing list and what is still not finished, also perhaps we could move goals to something like the SMART goal method where they are more directly measurable. Jamey agrees that figuring out how to better track progress would be useful and is worth becoming a high priority agenda item and finding and sticking to a timeline for that. He says in the past we've tried timing it so that we can have consensus before setting up the budget for the year so that the budget can be aligned with the goals.

Continuing onboarding Jordan we reviewed fundraising responsibilities and potential conflicts of interest. Taro used to have a helpful /donate bot command on the discord server that provided useful links to donate to TVGS. Paypal is the best way to get direct donations to TVGS it seems. Jordan mentions Benevity, which Taro was working on previously but wasn't able to fully set up. Heath+Jamey mentioned

working together (and with other board members) to make sure everyone is able to access the things they need to set up the connections that TVGS needs.

Jordan has a couple of potential conflicts of interest to keep in mind – he currently works for Veeva, and owns ToothPike Games LLC (a local game development studio). Tom is conflict free at the moment. Taro is interning at Hoodlin Mania and is a student at DigiPen. Heath works at Velan Studios. Darryl is a teacher at a capital region school. Laquana is a professor at Westchester University and does volunteer and some consulting work for National Fourth Family inc. Jamey has a game studio Spooky Bird LLC (a local game development studio) and teaches at Questar, which the board year on year votes to approve Jamey's teaching the class while counting as an employee of Questar.

6:48 Taro reviewed some essential portions of the bylaws, but since they're long the new board member was told to review them all offline. Taro noted that we will need to have a vote for a vice chair at some point since we are currently without a vice chair of the board. Jordan wanted to make sure he understood the divide in the TVGS events vs planning side and Taro was helpful in explaining the executive side vs the board as the planning side guiding TVGS.

7:00 Agenda point 3, Tom will be reaching back out to Darrian about looking for candidates to fill the executive director position. Taro confirmed with him that the job posting was approved, but the details such as the financial details and the form itself were not finished yet. Tom plans to check in with Darian this weekend and update the board meeting. Jamey mentions that it also depends on whether RPI will grant TVGS a sub-award this year. If they do grant a sub-award Jamey said and Tom confirmed that they didn't seem to have an issue with one of the highest (if not the highest) goals of that being put towards increasing the potential compensation for the executive director.

7:06 Mentioned Jordan working on fixing the TVGS homepage. According to Taro the board's currently identified problem is that the website is hosted in Azure but Azure wiped the database (after a warning, so not on Microsoft's shoulders). Azure was hosting one site for office inventory management+record management internal site that hadn't been used in a while, and the TVGS external facing homepage. The board had been looking for another hosting site that would handle updating and upgrading wordpress without it relying on a volunteer to do so. Taro pointed out that Tom had posted several suggestions. Jordan mentioned static hosting sites. Taro did want calendar management though which may not be possible on static sites. He mentioned having the ground truth being on the Meetup page and having that appear on our calendar would be useful, we do still have a Zapier solution so maybe that would be possible. Heath says the Boston indie meetup group uses meetup and it has their meetup page linked from their homepage so would be a useful resource when implementing our own setup. To Jamey the highest priority is to have something up that has important links and says we're updating the site. Right now it's very hard to get folks to where we are. We own our domain name but we believe it's now managed by Godaddy after Google sold it. Jordan will take a swing at making a quick temporary page and will chat with Taro and Jamey about the necessary steps to making one.

Taro then reprioritized the educational partnership update agenda item to discuss next. Jamey shared context: Generally we have an ongoing partnership with Questar which both promotes our educational goals as well as provides an income stream for the TVGS org. One of the challenges is that we're not yet in an established rhythm of setting up the contract over the summer so that the board can discuss and approve the partnership and contract and to have time to discuss and approve that Jamey can be classified as an employee of Questar/the principal instructor for that class. Jamey isn't sure what he

wants to do for the next school year since the contract delays have made it challenging for Jamey. The goal is to make it so that should the board decide to do another year we need to set up the contract over the summer. The past two years of the partnership the contract hasn't been signed until into the school year so they're using our curriculum free of charge and eventually we get paid for the co-instructors we bring in. Jamey thinks we should not let that drag into the school year. For this year Jamey says we got the contract signed at the start of the fourth quarter of the school year - plenty of the delays were on Questar (for instance they considered cutting the budget in half) and then Jamey had to discuss that from the position of the teacher. Because the contract took so long to sign, our usual co-instructors weren't available to teach any more. Financially that delay really hasn't worked in our favor. In terms of avoiding conflict of interest Jamey shouldn't be the person negotiating that on either end. Tom reached out to our legal partners about our pre-paid credits to see where we stand with those credits to start meeting with the Questar higher-ups early this summer.

Jamey requests the board's input on suggestions for how to approach the negotiations with Questar. For the amount of co-instructor hours they've approved, it started out when Jamey was just supporting it; they were basically paying for the full school year for Jamey to be there when the course was officially being taught by a Questar teacher. The next year the main teacher quit around October. When they classified Jamey as an employee they kept it the same for the first year perhaps partially because it was the middle of the year when that started. For the second year they wanted to cut it to half the hours from the prior year. Now they're trying to cut it to a quarter of the first year.

The next thing is we've never charged them for the curriculum which we own. We've treated this as the pilot program to help test our curriculum, but they shouldn't necessarily be assuming that and perhaps we need to license it to them. Those hours are for co-instructors that we bring in to supplement the curriculum and Jamey's teaching, not for Jamey's time. Jamey points out that we should vote on the two portions separately, the contract with Questar, and whether or not to move for Jamey to be a Questar employee (and it's up to the board). Jamey says he's pretty equally happy either way. Heath asks what the alternative would be if Jamey wasn't classified as a Questar employee. Tom responded saying it's an hourly rate that we work with them, and Questar didn't want to change the hourly rate just the hours. The question may be less on value for TVGS but more that the instructor has the support necessary to teach and the students receive a quality education. Jamey says there's likely to be improvement both in value and in quality if there are more hours of funding, and that TVGS has essentially made the class for them. The board discusses possible options for negotiating while acknowledging that we're all trying to work towards the same thing of providing a good game development education in the midst of national cuts and other difficulties.

Jamey will be posting a non-finalized list of grants discussing grant approval for the upcoming year the RPI center of excellence grant hasn't yet been approved

Jordan asks about overly verbose notes and whether we should trim some down (possibly including legal discussions with Questar). Tom says in his opinion it's alright, and that we review the minutes before posting them so we will review them at the next meeting.

7:53 Tom motioned to adjourn, Jamey seconded. All six ayes no nays. The meeting was adjourned at 7:54